

# DER OSCHDRESEGE

## 18. LENZING, 2017



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS  
REV - 0 - 2012

**Honoring:** die Oschdre: Helling, Nacht, Oschdra – *led by Jennifer Milby*

### Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice:

Sowilo (Sunne), Jera (Yaahr), Dagaz (Daag), Naudhiz (Not) – *led by Michelle Jones*

**Die Heiliching** - *led by Robert L. Schreiwer and Bob Headley*

*Bascht vun de Oschdre, verweih daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*  
*Brush of the Oschdre, bless this altar and this site!*  
*Beschitz uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe:*  
*Protect us with the Power of the Gods and Goddesses:*  
*Bei Wudan un Freid fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue;*  
*By Wudan and Freid, to build the community;*  
*Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde;*  
*By Tyr and Zisa, to uphold justice and frith;*  
*Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle;*  
*By Frey and Frey, to cut and to collect the bounty;*  
*Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche;*  
*By Thor and Sif, to empower the folk;*  
*Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire*  
*By Fraa Holle, to renew the folk;*  
*Bei de Oschdre fer der Welt bei Farrewe zu belewe;*  
*By the Oschdre, to vivify the world through color;*  
*Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,*  
*As the Hammer forges the Sickle,*  
*So duett die Sichel der Hammer fiedere.*  
*So does the Sickle feed the Hammer.*  
*'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide.*  
*It is the Wheel of Life, to sow and to cut.*  
*Bascht vun de Oschdre, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*  
*Brusch of the Oschdre, bless this altar and this site!*

*Heel!*

*Heel!*

*Heel!*

## **Leseschtick – Reading** – led by Larry Goble, Jr.

Bede's attestation of Eostre among the Angles, from *De temporum ratione*:

*Eosturmonath has a name which is now translated "Paschal month", and which was once called after a goddess of theirs named Eostre, in whose honour feasts were celebrated in that month. Now they designate that Paschal season by her name, calling the joys of the new rite by the time-honoured name of the old observance.*

## **Unser Zweck - Our Purpose** – led by Jennifer Milby

*Birth, death, rebirth*

*Are common themes in Deutsch culture.*

*We see them in our seasons, in the land, and in our souls.*

*The reading provides clues as to why we're here today.*

*First, We gather to celebrate the arrival of Spring  
which heralds the renewal of the Earth.*

*Second, they speak to the nature of our lore  
regarding a Goddess who lent her name to this season: Oschdra.*

*Very little about the Oschdre in the way of ancient lore has survived to reach us. Deutsch oral lore provides some additional insights. The Oschdre are counted in Braucherei among the Wane.*

*From Grimm (IV, 1371) we know her name lives on in places in the German lands.  
We know She is considered to be "White Lady" (III, 908)*

*Along with Her sisters, Helling and Nacht, She heralds the arrival of Spring.  
Like our ancestors, we yearn for Oschdra and the return of Spring.*

*Nacht is the personification of night, of darkness, and of black. Her shade, when added  
to those of Her Sisters, gives us many colors  
And Her time provides our eyes, our bodies, and our minds time to relax, to rejuvenate, and to dream.*

*Helling is the daylight and the shade of white. Bright and beaming -- sometimes even blinding,  
Her shade, when added to those of Her sisters, also gives us many colors.  
Her time provides us the ability to explore, to investigate, and to make our dreams realities.*

*Between Helling and Nacht is Oschdra, the goddess of the Dawn, Lady of gray yet also of color  
whom, along with Her sisters, we honor as the Bringers of Color and joy back to a winter-weary world.*

*Our modern conveniences separate us from the cycle of the seasons  
Thus, we do not, or cannot, understand fully  
what the return of Spring meant to our forebears.*

*Yet we do understand and share the desire for,  
and love of, Earth's beauty and bounty.  
It is the same longing for the end of winter.*

*Heathen symbols were brought forth by the Deutsch settlers and have become traditions,  
Though most people are not aware that they are sacred to this radiant deity.  
The restoration of the land is reflected in the so-called secular imagery of today.  
The rabbit, or the hare, is long seen in the western German lands as a symbol of fertility, emerging from the  
winter's sleep and exploring the world.  
And, of course, the egg represents new life.*

*So today we honor the Oschdre  
Helling, goddess of Daylight and the upspringing light, Nacht, goddess of Darkness and the easing rest,  
and Oschdra, She who stands between them, the Lady of the radiant dawn.  
The goddesses of the day's journey  
The goddesses of color and shade  
Spectacles who now bring joy and blessing  
To a land and a folk who are eagerly awaiting the springing of life in the land.*

## **Der Aaruf - The Invocation – led by Michelle Jones**

|                                                           |                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Liewe Haerrinne Oschdre!</i>                           | <i>Dear Ladies Oschdre!</i>                       |
| <i>Nacht, Ziebin vun der Nacht!</i>                       | <i>Nacht, Goddess of the Night!</i>               |
| <i>Oschdra, Ziebin vum Mariyelicht!</i>                   | <i>Goddess of the Dawn!</i>                       |
| <i>Helling, Ziebin vum Daagslich!</i>                     | <i>Helling, Goddess of Daylight!</i>              |
| <i>Farewegewwerinne!</i>                                  | <i>Color-Givers!</i>                              |
| <i>Mir bidde Eich mit uns zu bsuche</i>                   | <i>We bid Ye to visit with us</i>                 |
| <i>Un mit uns heit es Gleichwicht zu feiere</i>           | <i>and with us today to celebrate the Equinox</i> |
| <i>Seid unser verehrtere Gaschtinne</i>                   | <i>Be our honored guests</i>                      |
| <i>un unseri Freindschaft verdeele</i>                    | <i>and share in our in our kinship</i>            |
| <i>Helft uns die Winderdunkelheit zerickzugloppe</i>      | <i>Help us to beat back the winter darkness</i>   |
| <i>So mir em Friehling sei Mariyelicht aablicke kenne</i> | <i>So that we can see the dawn of spring.</i>     |
| <i>Heele!</i>                                             | <i>Hail!</i>                                      |

## **Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths – led by Shaun Shupe**

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle  
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.  
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

## Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings – led by Shaun Shupe

*Zu Eich, Liewe Haerrine Oschdre  
 Mir hewwe daer Seidel aa  
 Mir biede daer Met un daer Seider aa  
 Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker  
 Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaardeet  
 un vun unserer Gemeeschaft  
 un vun unserer Gemietlichkeet  
 Darrich Eich binne mir uns fescht aa  
 Losst 's immer so sei!*

*To Ye, Dear Ladies Oschdre  
 We lift this stein  
 We offer this mead and this cider  
 And give these other gifts  
 As a symbol of our thankfulness  
 and of our community  
 and our belonging  
 Through Thee we bind ourselves together  
 May it always be so!*

*Heel Nacht!  
 Heel Helling!  
 Heel Oschdra!  
 Heel zu de Ziewe!  
 Heel zu de Vorgenger!  
 Heel zu de Noochkummer!  
 Heel die Gemeeschaft!*

*Hail Nacht!  
 Hail Helling!  
 Hail Oschdra!  
 Hail to the deities!  
 Hail to the ancestors!  
 Hail to the descendants!  
 Hail to the community!*

## Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution – Michelle Jones and Jennifer Milby

## Der Sege - The Blessing – led by Shaun Shupe

*When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):*

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns  
 Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*From the gods to the Earth to us  
 From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk  
 Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.  
 Hail!*

## Zum Schluss - In Closing – led by Jennifer Milby

*Heit beginne mir en neii Yaahreszeit  
 un baue do en schtandhafliches Bindnis zamme  
 Mit de Ziewe  
 Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck  
 Losst uns zamme immer schtarricker waxe.*

*Today we begin a new season  
 and build here a steadfast alliance together  
 with the Deities  
 And through our common purpose  
 Let us all grow stronger together.*

*Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.*

*This Sege is closed.*

## **Zu de Wichde - To The Wights** – *led by Michelle Jones*

*Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde*

*Vun desem Land*

*Un mir bedanke uns 'ne*

*Fer ihrer Schirm*

*Heel!*

*We give also an offering to the Wights*

*of this Land*

*And we are thankful to them*

*For their protection*

*Hail!*

## ***Discussion Topics***

The Life, Death, Rebirth Cycle: Yule is associated with Rebirth. At Groundhog Day, we celebrate the "pregnancy" phase of the cycle of Life. Oschdre is the propagation (the "springing" forth) of life: the birth and infancy phase of the Life cycle.

In Deitsch, Oschdre is a plural noun, perhaps indicating a multiple-day holiday (Grimm, I, 299). This plurality is reflected in Braucherei's three-day observance of Oschdre (March 19, 20, 21). Another possibility is that the Oschdre were multiple goddesses whose individual names (Helling, Nacht, and Oschdra) may now be known only through the surviving myth as related from Schuylkill County, PA (see notes in the Oschdre myth).

### **Reckoning Oschdre in Lenzing (March) vs. Oschdret (April)**

Bede's attestation of the Angles' holiday, Eostre, places the observance among that tribe in Eosturmonath, which was the fourth month of the Old English calendar. The fourth month on the Urglaawe calendar is Oschdret, which is a cognate of the Angles' name for the same month. So why do we observe Oschdre in Lenzing (March) rather than April? There could be several reasons for this time discrepancy.

In Urglaawe, we tie Oschdre to the Spring Equinox, but the time of the celebration for our ancestors would very likely have shifted in response to the actual weather conditions for a given year. Thus, those in the south may have generally held their observance earlier than those in the north.

Time reckoning between the ancient past and the present faces many challenges, which complicates research. Keeping that in mind, another theory is that Oschdre was once a longer holiday, (perhaps twelve days like Yuul, Entschtanning, Wonnezeit, and, as observed in Urglaawe, Allelieweziel).

Using current Urglaawe calendar dates, a twelve-day observance would take the holiday to March 21-April 2. Since Urglaawe "days" begin at sundown the preceding night, the evening of March 31 is actually 1. Oschdret/April 1. Thus, the only inconsistency between the theory and the calendar would be the infrequent occurrence of the equinox falling prior to sundown on March 19.

### **Oschdra**

Oschdra's name has a sense of the "east," indicating the dawn. Thus, we see the beauty of the goddess Oschdra in the light of the dawn, particularly the brilliant, multi-colored light manifesting itself in the reflections off of the clouds.

### **Helling**

This name literally means "daylight," and, despite the similarity in appearance between "Helling" and "Delling," which is a Norse god whose name means "daylight," there is no evidence of a specific connection. There is a shred of oral evidence of "Daag" ("day") being personified as Nacht (see below) was, and, perhaps, there is a familial structure that includes Daag that has been lost to time. Helling, though is the personification of daylight and the shade of white.

### **Nacht**

This name literally means "night." Again, although Scandinavian lore reports the name Nótt as the personification of night, there is no direct evidence of any sustained relationship between the Scandinavian lore and our Oschdre myth. Linguistically, those, the two names are related. It is

important to note that Nacht's role is not negative. We have a tendency to be celebrating the returning light, but Nacht's role in the myth makes gray and many shades of color possible. Night provides life, even plants, with necessary rest.

### **Oschdre Holiday**

A huge portion of American secular Easter traditions came through the Deitsch culture, including the Easter Rabbit, eggs, and egg trees (see the book *Eastertide in Pennsylvania*, by Alfred L. Shoemaker). Hares and eggs, both symbols of fertility, are sacred to Oschdra. Indeed, after a long winter of muted and paleness, we look forward to the Oschdra painting the world with brilliant color.

Oschdre is also a time for us to honor our relationship with animals. While we are to be live deliberately and consciously within the Zusaagpflicht or Zusaagfassing (see below), the association of the hare and the egg with this holiday provide an opportunity to pay special attention to the role of animals in our lives.

### **Muunraad**

We are currently in the Grabb (Crow or Raven) moon, which is the twelfth new moon since the Spring Equinox 2016. It is the last moon of the 2016 lunar calendar year. It began on February 26. The Crow and the Raven, as scavengers, teach those born during the most difficult time of year how to survive. The corvids often serve as an alarm that warns other birds of danger. Thus, those born under this sign are often prophetic or perceptive of threats. Also, this is usually the last moon sign of the lunar year, and both birds are associated with death, transitions, Wudan, and completion of cycles. The Wheel of the Year operates on a tilt. There is the new calendar year, which is heralded by the liminal goddess Berchta, and there is the new spiritual year, which follows the lunar cycle and is usually transitioned during the Crow/Raven moon.

First New Moon of Lunar Year 2017: Holzhaahne: Monday, March 27 10:57 PM EDT.

In 2017, we do not have the challenge that we had in 2015 from a thirteenth new moon beginning just before the equinox.

In 2015, a new moon occurred several hours before the equinox; thus, that new moon was actually a holdover (the thirteenth new moon) from 2014's lunar year. It was called the Elbedritsch (Snipe) moon because of its shifting nature going between existing and non-existing from year to year. Children born under this sign have a highly intelligent, yet somewhat shifty, nature. Interesting, the Elbedritsch is associated with the shades of black, gray, and (to a lesser extent) white an almost chameleon-like ability to blend into the world around it.

This year, though, it is more simple.

First New Moon after Oschdre = Holzhaane Moon on the traditional Braucherei lunar calendar, which emerges primarily from the Oley-Pikeville area. The Holzhaane Moon begins on Monday, March 27, 2017. Note that the names of some of the animals on the calendar may bear some Lenape influence; this is likely the result of exchanges between Brauchers and Lenape medicine folk in the early settlement period. The associated lore, though, seems to be quite European.

The Woodcock Moon begins with the first new moon after the end of winter. In the natural world at this time we can find the woodcock involved in its complex mating dance at sunsets in open areas near water. The time of hunger is over for those who know the ways of the woodcock. The woodcock lives in marginal lands and finds food where others can't. The woodcock teaches us to adapt to our spring environment and find the new greens and spring foods to cleanse our bodies after the long winter. The woodcock teaches us to take advantage of opportunities given at this time, and to act with speed and timeliness. This is a time of plowing and preparation of our fields for the abundance that is to come. - *Jesse Tobin*

**Stewardship (Verwalting) and Zusaagpflicht / Zusaagfassing** As Spring sets in and the land is teeming with young life, it is a most appropriate time to ponder the virtue of Verwalting is the ancillary virtue of Stewardship. Careful management of resources and the world around us is a core component of Urglaawe, of Braucherei, and of the traditional Deitsch culture. Akin to the Noble Virtues of Discipline and Hospitality, Verwalting helps to create a stable living environment for all of creation.

Stewardship does not mean a lack of progress or an austere lifestyle. It does, though, indicate that progress must not be reckless and that resources must not be squandered in order to achieve immediate goals. It is nearly impossible to live on Earth and not have a negative impact upon or alter one's environment. However, we can strive to minimize the impact, to correct or to ameliorate damages done previously, and to improve our circumstances going forward.

This aspect of Deitsch culture does not emanate from post-modern jargon. The virtue of Stewardship is closely associated with the *Zusaagpflicht* or the Sacred Duty. Several terms are used in Deitsch and English to identify this concept, including also "Zusaagfassing," which translates to "Sacred Promise" in English. The latter had been the more commonly used term until recently, when a book came out by the same title but with a different concept. You will still hear the term used in Braucherei, but the more common term is now the former, *Zusaagpflicht*/Sacred Duty.

No one really knows how old this concept is or even whether it springs forth from the Heathen era, but its concept is certainly consistent with Heathen worldviews. As part of a living culture, though, it has evolved within Deitsch culture (and presumably Palatinate, Swabian, Westphalian, Hessian, Silesian, Alsatian, and Swiss cultures prior to emigration) over the centuries.

Each domain (humanity, plants, and animals) has had, since time immemorial, roles to perform in the cycle of life. The roles evolved over the course of time and developed into an unwritten or spiritual social contract (to use Hobbesian terminology).

Our modern society separates us not only from the reality of the seasons but also from the plant and animal kingdoms. Although we are fortunate enough to live close to the land here in this area, much of our food is still processed and appears as convenient little meals. Stewardship includes recognizing and respecting the loss of life, whether animal or vegetable, that resulted in that meal.

Recently, there have been efforts here in Berks County to reduce sludge farming (the disposal of wastewater on farmlands), to put an end to inhumane treatment on puppy mills, and to end some of the more destructive practices of Big Agro that have resulted in a great volume of food but, very likely, in less actual nutrition. These practices are violations of the Sacred Promise.

As almost any good, effective manager knows, being at the top of an organization does not mean that power can be used indiscriminately. Eventually, morale breaks down among the staff. Rancor develops, and the health of the organization grows sour. The same arrangement exists throughout the physical world. The fact that mankind can do something does not mean he should do it. Morale is breaking down throughout the physical world as a result of the abuses therein. In a manner of Shyamalan's *The Happening* (which was filmed not far from here, actually), the land may someday rebel or simply to die off.

So what can we, as Urglaawer, along with our fellow Heathens, do? We are a small segment of society. However, small rocks can create a big wake from a splash. The most effective way of making change is to lead by example. Be conscious of the world around you. Take care of your land. Treat the life around you (including humans!) with respect. When possible, know what you are eating and where it comes from (admittedly a difficult task!). Manage your resources with deliberation and a view of the future (this is a large challenge for me when it comes to financial resources). And, to the extent of your personal inclination, act politically for change.

The Deutsch culture, up until very recently, was very geared towards the stewardship of the land and of resources. In most places, it still is. However, a mindless consumer culture is creeping in, and, with its promises of gratification, it is a threat to the culture of this region and to the Zusaagpflicht.

### **The Myth of Die Oschdre**

#### ----- PREFACE -----

Rob had only heard parts of this when he was younger, mostly from relatives or friends of relatives from the stretch between Ashfield and Bowmanstown (version A), PA but also from the Berwick area (version B). In 2012, Rob asked around the two areas and got leads on some people who may know about the story, and he ended up with 10 new informants for a total of 17. Other informants were familiar with one or two points of the story but not enough to make a significant contribution. More than half of the informants came from farther south, in a stretch from Orwigsburg to New Ringgold (version C). Their versions of the story bore more information and some distinct contrasts with those of the two northern areas. Thus, this particular myth has undergone some reconstruction using as a base the information that the informants provided. The more important variations are noted with footnotes below.

It should also be mentioned that only four informants (all of whom self-identified as knowing Braucherei or Hexerei), looked at any aspect of this as being anything beyond a metaphor. Informant #11 specifically referred to the three Ladies as "goddesses"; #8 referred to Oschdra as a "helpful entity"; #13 and #15 referred to the sisters as "helpful spirits." Therefore, it cannot be said that this was a widespread myth with religious significance historically, but it is applicable to the modern perspectives of Urglaawe.

It is also by no means certain that this is of any particular antiquity; it may be a story that arose in the foothills since the settlement. Thus, it is prudent to encourage readers to look at this as a new myth

or a reconstruction or a retelling of a regional folk tale while allowing individuals or kindreds to view it as they will.

Michelle A. Jones and Robert L. Schreiwer

### ----- Die Oschdre -----

Three sisters, Helling, Nacht, and Oschdra (1), gathered together at a point on the world they called East (2). Each sister wore a cloak of transformative power. Helling wore a cloak of light; Nacht, a cloak of darkness; and Oschdra wore a cloak that could not be seen. They decided to meet at this moment because they were bored with the blandness of existence and wished to make it all appear more interesting and exciting.

Nacht stepped forward first and as She did so, Her cloak covered the world and everything beneath Her and it became black. Oschdra, seeing what happened when Her sister progressed, moved forward next. Only this time, Oschdra's cloak seemingly had no effect on the world below. Next Helling walked forward, and as She did, the world below Her and Her cloak was cast in white. Most amazingly, as Helling's white touched Nacht's black under where Oschdra stood, Oschdra's cloak and everything below Her transformed and could now be seen in a new shade She called "gray."

Oschdra then called upon a pair of Finches (3), Distelfresser and Himmelflucht (4) to fly from Her right hand, a place She called North, to Her left hand, a place She called South. As they would make their flight, everything in their path would be washed in gray.

Distelfresser and Himmelflucht agreed, but asked Oschdra to grant them a simple request: Himmelflucht's eggs shall also be gray so that she could see them regardless of Helling or Nacht being above them. Oschdra happily granted their request, and the Finches began their flight.

The three Sisters continued their walk around the world. Nacht providing the black hue, Helling, the white, and Oschdra, gray. After nine days, Oschdra became restless once again. She was unhappy that she could only create a tint on the world by standing between Her sisters. She wanted to provide Her very own hue. She looked upon Her cloak and closed Her eyes. She imagined one side of the cloak afire with a varied warm glow and She called it red, orange, and yellow. She imagined the other side luminescent with a cool iridescence and She called it green, blue, and violet.

Oschdra opened Her eyes, and now Her cloak bore all these hues which she called "Farewe," but in Her own tongue (5). Now as Oschdra walked from the East to the West (6), the skies radiated with the new colors. Her sisters saw the change, and they admired Oschdra's craft.

Together the three Sisters of the East, thenceforth known as the Oschdre, decided to do more. Helling added white to the colors and Nacht added black. Oschdra's palette grew and the Sisters loved their work (7). The colors appeared in the sky but not elsewhere in the world. Oschdra and Her Sisters wished for the whole world to emerge with the colors of their work so they sought the assistance of the most prolific of the animal world to help them with their work. They found Haas (8) and asked him to transform the world wherever his tail went by saturating everything in its path with the colors of the Ladies' craft. Haas agreed but asked in return that all of his descendents would inherit his role as the bearer of color.

The Oschdre Sisters agreed. While Helling and Nacht stood opposite one another, Oschdra sent Haas forth. Haas was directed to begin at the nest of the Finches, who, having completed their journey, were now flying South to North. Oschdra declared to Himmelflucht, "With Haas' colors, your eggs will always be in your sight."

Just as Haas painted the last of the eggs (9), Distelfresser landed in the nest to check on them and he was pleased. Haas' tail brushed against him as Haas was leaving and Distelfresser's plumage transformed to vibrant yellow, blue, green, and red (10).

Haas continued on his way, and to this day, wherever Haas goes, color follows his tail (11).

----- NOTES -----

(1) Only two informants (#13 and #15, both of the New Ringgold area; version C) had names for all three of the ladies: Helling ("Daylight"), Nacht ("Night"), Oschdra ("of the East"). The northern versions (A, B) only listed one individual, the Lady of the East, Oschdra, rather than three. Others in the southern stretch (C) knew one name or another or simply referred to them as "Schweschdere" (sisters).

(2) Informant #10 referred to the Lady's home as "Mariyeland" (sometimes spelled "Maryeland"), which could be influenced by the Deutsch name for Morgenland (Lehigh County) and literally means "Tomorrow Land," referring to the East.

(3) There is a distinct difference in versions here. Version A refers to a goose while version C refers to a pair of finches. Version B makes no mention of this at all. Rob initially went with the goose route because that was the version he was most acquainted with. However, the goldfinch has as many informants and all of the informants from the area of version C indicated some knowledge (albeit in some cases passive) of the finches being part of the story.

(4) Informant #13 (version C) was the sole provider of the names of the finches, and she had stammered significantly on the male's name as she tried to remember what her father had related to her. She ultimately provided Distelfresser ("Thistle-Eater") and Himmelflucht ("Heaven-Flight") as the name of the female. As these were the only names provided, we used them.

(5) Whatever word a goddess would use in the language of the Hohegegend (the realm of deity) that would be the equivalent of Farewe ("colors").

(6) Almost every informant in versions A and C reported this "walk" from the East to the West. Version B was more simple in a reference to the dawn bringing the colors.

(7) Version A included mixing them together to form the earth color brown.

(8) Haas ("Hare"). It should be noted that the purpose of the story as related in version B by informant #7 was to explain where the Easter Bunny came from, and the colors were more a secondary tale. In version C, it was the opposite; the purpose of the story was to explain where colors, including those of the Distelfink, came from. Version A fell somewhere in between with more focus on the origination of the colors of the world.

(9) This is where the difficulty with version C comes in as the most typical reflections of eggs at Oschdre/Easter are goose eggs and chicken eggs. The only relatively widespread association with smaller bird eggs are those of Robins, who are announcers of springtime in Deutsch lore. The variety of colors and shades among house finch eggs, though, is not to be dismissed. And, also, sometimes a metaphor is just a metaphor.

(10) There was some disagreement among the version C informants of this segment. Two informants stated yellow and called it Distelfink.. two stated yellow and red and called it Distelfink... and three related yellow, blue, green, red and called it by both Distelfink and Bird of Paradise. It is anyone's guess whether any of these was the original version or any/all were an alteration to the story to reflect the artistic concepts of the Distelfink/Bird of Paradise depictions. The one conclusion we do draw from this particular tale, though, is that Distelfink got its colors from Haas on his mission to paint the world. Stressing again: It is also by no means certain that this is of any particular antiquity; it may be a story that arose in the foothills since the settlement.

(11) This is probably the most widespread portion that people in general remember, even if vaguely, outside of the informants on the list.

----- INFORMANTS -----

- #1. Orpha Balliet, Bowmanstown (A)
- #2. I. Billig, Bowmanstown (A)
- #3. B. Bowman, Bowmanstown (A)
- #4. A. Henderson, New Jersey (A) note, originally from Parryville
- #5. S. Eckhart, Ashfield (A)
- #6. Permission not attained, Berwick (B)
- #7. Willard Fritzinger, Berwick (B)
- #8. Permission not attained, Andreas (A)
- #9. D. Fidler, Orwigsburg (C)
- #10. J. Gray, Ashfield (A)
- #11. Requested anonymity, Auburn (C)
- #12. Chester K., Hazleton (B)
- #13. Emma H., New Ringgold (C)
- #14. Requested anonymity, Deer Lake (C)
- #15. Stan K., New Ringgold (C)
- #16. N. Alwers, Orwigsburg (C)
- #17. E. Dreher, New Ringgold (C)